

THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG  
HKU BUSINESS SCHOOL

PMGM7005

Dynamics of Multinational Corporations

GENERAL INFORMATION

**Instructor:** Filippo Carlo Wezel

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**Phone:** 39178223

**Consultation times:**  
Monday 8:30AM-9:30AM

**Teaching Assistant:**  
Huang Yi

**Recommended Textbook:**

Peng, M. *Global Business*. 5<sup>th</sup> edition Cengage Learning

**Cases:**

We will learn from both history and the present day. Classic case studies allow us to dissect pivotal decisions from MNCs' pasts and apply their lessons to the future. Recent case studies put us at the forefront of current business challenges, where we will formulate strategic responses to ensure sustainable growth.

**The following programming languages are used in this course:**

English

| COURSE DESCRIPTION                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                   |
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| <p>This course provides a strategic framework for understanding multinational corporations (MNCs) in the global economy. It focuses on the core challenges managers face, from analyzing complex international environments to making critical decisions about market entry, competitive strategy, and organizational structure. The objective is to prepare students to evaluate and navigate the key dynamics of global business.</p>             |                                   |
| COURSE OBJECTIVES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                   |
| <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. To provide a detailed understanding of the complexity of managing multinational corporations in global business environments</li> <li>2. To provide an understanding of the theories of global business; and the strategic and operational factors that determine the success and growth of multinational corporations</li> <li>3. To prepare students for career in the global business field</li> </ol> |                                   |
| PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                   |
| <p>PLO1: Acquisition and internalization of knowledge of the program discipline</p> <p>PLO2: Application and integration of knowledge</p> <p>PLO3: Inculcating professionalism and leadership</p> <p>PLO4: Developing global outlook</p> <p>PLO5: Mastering communication skills</p>                                                                                                                                                                |                                   |
| COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                   |
| Course Learning Outcomes                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Aligned Program Learning Outcomes |
| CLO1: Understand the global business theories and concepts                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | PLO1, 2, 4                        |
| CLO2: Identify the managerial opportunities and challenges in a global context                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | PLO1, 2, 3, 4                     |
| CLO3: Apply theories and concepts to analyze the performance determinants of multinational corporations; and the strategic and operational alternatives available to multinational corporations to expand in global markets                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | PLO1, 2, 3, 4                     |
| CLO4: Demonstrate effective communication skill                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | PLO5                              |

| COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES |                                 |                       |                                  |
|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------|-----------------------|----------------------------------|
| Course Teaching and Learning Activities |                                 | Expected contact hour | Study Load (% of study)          |
|                                         |                                 |                       |                                  |
| T&L1. Interactive lectures              |                                 | 30                    | 23%                              |
| T&L2. Case discussions                  |                                 | 20                    | 15%                              |
| T&L3. Assignment                        |                                 | 40                    | 31%                              |
| T&L4. Lecture preparation & Self-study  |                                 | 40                    | 31%                              |
| Total                                   |                                 | 130                   | 100%                             |
| Assessment Methods                      | Brief Description               | Weight                | Aligned Course Learning Outcomes |
| A1. Group Project                       | Group Project                   | 50%                   | CLO1, 2, 3, 4                    |
| A2. Class Participation                 | In-class activities & role-play | 30%                   | CLO1, 2, 3, 4                    |
| A3. Individual Assignment               | Individual case analysis report | 20%                   | CLO1, 2, 3, 4                    |
| Total                                   |                                 | 100%                  |                                  |

## A1. Group Project (50%)

### Group Project Overview

Your team will act as global strategy analysts for a multinational corporation (MNC). The CEO, concerned about sustainable growth amid current challenges like the global economic downturn, has tasked your group with developing a strategic proposal. Your objective is to create and justify a new business idea—such as a new product or service—for introduction into a new market or host country.

Based on your selected group assignment, each group will prepare your presentations in two phases:

1. Group presentation: Answer first set of questions
2. Final group presentation: Answer second set of questions

Each group at the end of the course will submit a formal written report. This report should provide a detailed response to the four key project questions, allowing you to elaborate beyond the time constraints of your board presentation. For each question, clearly articulate your final recommendation, outline the alternative options considered, and present the supporting evidence for your choice. The report must present a clear, actionable proposal for how the company should proceed.

## A2. Class Participation (30%)

Your active participation is essential to the success of this class. Engaging in discussions and activities will deepen your own understanding and enrich the learning experience for everyone. Participation is highly valued and will be assessed based on the quality of your contributions, such as making insightful connections to course concepts, offering constructive feedback, and bringing unique perspectives to our dialogue. The evaluation is based on the quality of an *individual's contribution*, but when the activity involves group discussion it will be shared among the members of the group. The Teaching Assistant will track and document your participation in all activities.

## A3. Individual Assignment (20%)

Please submit an individual report of 2-page, double-spaced, 12-point font and standard one-inch margins. Submit your final report directly to Moodle.

**No late assignment will be accepted.** Details will be provided in Session 1.

| Course Grade Descriptors             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| A+, A, A-                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>• Handling questions professionally</li> <li>• High participation in discussions</li> <li>• Present arguments that have an element of originality</li> <li>• Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the group project with very good analytical and problem solving skills</li> <li>• Excellent performance in individual assignment</li> </ul>                                 |
| B+, B, B-                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>• Handling questions in a logical way</li> <li>• Good participation in discussions</li> <li>• Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook</li> <li>• Achieve a standard of good performance in the group project with good analytical and problem solving skills</li> <li>• Good performance in individual assignment</li> </ul>                                            |
| C+, C, C-                            | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Fairly address questions as set</li> <li>• Some participation in discussions</li> <li>• Present arguments in a well-structure manner</li> <li>• Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the group project with reasonably acceptable analytical and problem solving skills</li> <li>• Acceptable performance in individual assignment</li> </ul>                                   |
| D+, D                                | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Barely address questions as set</li> <li>• Minimal or no participation in discussions</li> <li>• Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner</li> <li>• Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the group project with barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills</li> <li>• Marginally acceptable performance in individual assignment</li> </ul> |
| F                                    | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Unable or unwilling to handle questions</li> <li>• Minimal or no participation in discussions</li> <li>• Present arguments poorly</li> <li>• Fail to meet a standard of the group project with inadequate analytical and problem solving skills</li> <li>• Poorly performance in individual assignment</li> </ul>                                                                        |
| Assessment Rubrics for Group Project |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

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| A+, A, A- | <p><u>Content of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presentation was highly successful at communicating the essential elements of the analysis and conclusions to the audience in a logical manner.</li> <li>▪ All concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified when necessary.</li> <li>▪ The presentation demonstrated a deep understanding and comprehension of the topic (theory and practical application).</li> <li>▪ There was clear evidence of independent and critical thinking.</li> </ul> <p><u>Execution of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presenter(s) displayed excellent verbal skills and delivered a highly interesting and coherent presentation.</li> <li>▪ Visual aids were appropriately used and clear.</li> <li>▪ The presentation was completed within the time limit.</li> </ul>                  |
| B+, B, B- | <p><u>Content of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presentation was successful at communicating the essential elements of the analysis and conclusions to the audience in a logical manner.</li> <li>▪ Most concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified when necessary.</li> <li>▪ The presentation demonstrated a sound understanding and comprehension of the topic (theory and practical application).</li> <li>▪ There was evidence of independent and critical thinking.</li> </ul> <p><u>Execution of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presenter(s) displayed good verbal skills and delivered an interesting and coherent presentation.</li> <li>▪ Visual aids were appropriately used and clear.</li> <li>▪ The presentation was completed within the time limit.</li> </ul>                                        |
| C+, C, C- | <p><u>Content of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presentation adequately communicated the essential elements of the analysis and conclusions to the audience in a logical manner.</li> <li>▪ Most but not all concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified when necessary.</li> <li>▪ The presentation demonstrated an acceptable level of understanding and comprehension of the topic (theory and practical application).</li> <li>▪ There was limited evidence of independent and critical thinking.</li> </ul> <p><u>Execution of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presenter(s) displayed mediocre verbal skills and delivered a somewhat interesting and coherent presentation.</li> <li>▪ Visual aids were appropriately used and clear.</li> <li>▪ The presentation was completed within the time limit.</li> </ul> |

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| D+, D                                             | <p><u>Content of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presentation only covered some basic elements of the analysis and conclusions to the audience in a somewhat logical manner.</li> <li>▪ Very few concepts were thoroughly explained and clarified when necessary.</li> <li>▪ The presentation demonstrated very limited level of understanding and comprehension of the topic (theory and practical application).</li> <li>▪ There was very limited evidence of independent and critical thinking.</li> </ul> <p><u>Execution of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presenter(s) displayed minimal verbal skills and the presentation lacked in coherence.</li> <li>▪ Visual aids were somewhat appropriately used but unclear.</li> <li>▪ The presentation was completed within the time limit.</li> </ul> |
| F                                                 | <p><u>Content of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ The presentation failed to address the basic and key issues of the analysis and conclusions.</li> <li>▪ The presentation did not demonstrate sufficient understanding and comprehension of the topic.</li> </ul> <p><u>Execution of presentation</u></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>▪ Verbal skills were inadequate.</li> <li>▪ Visual aids were inadequately used.</li> <li>▪ The presentation was not completed within the time limit.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| <b>Assessment Rubrics for Class Participation</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| A+, A, A-                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>•High participation in discussions</li> <li>•Always attend in-class discussions</li> <li>•Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>•Handling questions professionally</li> <li>•Present arguments that have an element of originality</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| B+, B, B-                                         | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>•Good participation in discussions</li> <li>•Often attend in-class discussions</li> <li>•Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>•Handling questions in a logical way</li> <li>•Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

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| C+, C, C-                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Some participation in discussions</li> <li>• Sometimes attend in-class discussions</li> <li>• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Fairly address questions as set</li> <li>• Present arguments in a well-structure manner</li> </ul>                |
| D+, D                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Minimal or no participation in discussions</li> <li>• Rarely attend in-class discussions</li> <li>• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Barely address questions as set</li> <li>• Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner</li> </ul> |
| F                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Minimal or no participation in discussions</li> <li>• Almost never attend in-class discussions</li> <li>• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Unable or unwilling to handle questions</li> <li>• Present arguments poorly</li> </ul>                 |
| <b>Assessment Rubrics for Individual Assignment</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
| A+, A, A-                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a strong understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>• Present arguments that have an element of originality</li> <li>• Achieve a standard of excellent performance in the assessment with very good analytical and problem solving skills</li> </ul>                |
| B+, B, B-                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a good understanding of all relevant knowledge</li> <li>• Present arguments that go beyond the lecture and textbook</li> <li>• Achieve a standard of good performance in the assessment with good analytical and problem solving skills</li> </ul>                        |
| C+, C, C-                                           | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a basic understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Present arguments in a well-structure manner</li> <li>• Meet a standard of acceptable performance in the assessment with reasonably acceptable analytical and problem solving skills</li> </ul>                 |
| D+, D                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a minimum understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Present arguments in a marginally acceptable manner</li> <li>• Meet a standard of marginally acceptable performance in the assessments with barely adequate analytical and problem solving skills</li> </ul>  |
| F                                                   | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Demonstrate a poor understanding of the concepts involved</li> <li>• Present arguments poorly</li> <li>• Fail to meet a standard of passing the assessment with inadequate analytical and problem solving skills</li> </ul>                                                           |



| COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
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| <p>Session 1: Introduction to dynamics of multinational corporations (MNCs)</p> <p>Session 2: Going global: Strategizing; Where, When, How? Case discussion</p> <p>Session 3: Going global: Customizing to new market. Case discussion</p> <p>Session 4: Simulation Game</p> <p>Session 5: Going global: Organizing</p> <p>Session 6: Group Presentations</p> <p>Session 7: Going global: Aligning culture &amp; people</p> <p>Session 8: Case discussion</p> <p>Session 9: Group Presentations, Final</p> <p>Session 10: Your learning and wrap up</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| Note: The schedules are subject to changes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| To be announced on Moodle.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <p>SETL survey will be conducted around the end of the semester.</p> <p>Presentation feedback will be provided via email or Moodle.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| COURSE POLICY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
| <p>Students are required to attend all classes on time. If you have some reasons for not being able to attend a class, you should inform the <u>Teaching Assistant</u> beforehand.</p> <p>Students are required to attend <b>at least 70% of classes in each course</b>. Otherwise they shall be treated as failing the course.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| ACADEMIC CONDUCT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| <p>Plagiarism and copying of copyright materials are serious offences and may lead to disciplinary actions. You should read the chapters on "Plagiarism" and "Copyright" in the Undergraduate/Postgraduate Handbook for details. You are strongly advised to read the booklet entitled "What is Plagiarism?" which was distributed to you upon your admission into the University, a copy of which can be found at <a href="http://www.hku.hk/plagiarism">www.hku.hk/plagiarism</a> . A booklet entitled "Plagiarism and How to Avoid it" is also available from the Main Library.</p> <p><i>To avoid intellectual property and copyright infringement, and/or violation of the Personal Data (Privacy) Ordinance, <b>DO NOT upload</b> HKU teaching-related materials including but not limited to course materials, marking schemes, examination papers, etc. to websites. If you have done so in the past, you are asked to take steps to take down relevant materials immediately. The university reserves the right for the material usage.</i></p> |